



PMM PORTFOLIO · CASE STUDY

Making the Case for APAC

How a self-initiated observation became a leadership-ready international market expansion assessment at Tripleseat — researched, framed, and written end to end by one person.

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A design seat, a market-sized observation



The company

Tripleseat is a US-based event and venue management SaaS platform used by restaurants, hotels, and unique venues to sell, plan, and run private events — spanning lead capture, proposals, floorplans (Tripleseat Floorplans), and payments (PartyPay).

My day job: Production Designer on the Floorplans team — a creative role, not a strategy seat. That distinction is the point of this story.



The spark

Working inside the product daily, I kept seeing signals that Tripleseat's category problem — venues running high event volume on spreadsheets and phone calls — existed at even larger scale across APAC, with no comparable incumbent.

I pitched the observation to our Creative Director. The reply:

“Put it in writing — something I can forward to leadership.”

Turn enthusiasm into a decision-ready document

The question leadership actually needed answered: **should Tripleseat expand into APAC — and if so, where first, in what sequence, and validated how?**



No mandate, no budget

Built entirely alongside my design workload. No analyst subscriptions, no research team — every data point sourced from public reports and verified against a second source where possible.



A skeptical, senior audience

The document would travel without me in the room. It had to anticipate objections, admit its own limitations, and read like an operator wrote it — not a fan of the idea.



A genuinely open question

APAC is not one market. Fourteen candidate countries with wildly different price tolerance, English proficiency, hotel infrastructure, and competitive density had to become one clear recommendation.

A framework with evidence, not a hunch with charts

Three deliverables, one narrative

2 pp

Executive Summary

A standalone, forwardable read for time-poor leadership.

7 pp

Market Research Brief

Sourced evidence: sizing, growth, competition, infrastructure.

15 pp

Consolidated Assessment v2

Evidence merged with a five-phase validation framework, pilot design, financial model structure, and risk register.

Every market scored on the same seven lenses

- **MICE & events market size + growth** · Coherent Market Insights, Grand View Research
- **GDP per capita & price tolerance** · IMF 2025
- **Labor-cost economics of the ROI case** · salary benchmarks
- **Branded hotel supply & pipeline** · Lodging Econometrics, Horwath HTL, Hotelivate
- **English proficiency** · EF EPI 2025
- **Payment rails for PartyPay** · UPI, PromptPay, QRIS, DuitNow, VietQR
- **Competitive density** · Cvent, iVvy, Social Tables, Prismm

Fourteen markets, three tiers, one sequence

TIER 1 — ENTER FIRST

Australia / NZ · Singapore

English-native, chain-dense, high willingness to pay. Australia offers a beatable incumbent (iVvy) with documented onboarding complaints; Singapore's MICE demand is literally government-subsidised (BEiS co-funds up to ~50% of qualifying event costs).

TIER 2 — BUILD TOWARD

India · Southeast Asia

The largest prize with the hardest go-to-market. Enormous event volume and record hotel pipelines, but pricing, relationships, and compliance demand real localisation before entry.

TIER 3 — MONITOR ONLY

Japan · South Korea · Greater China

Big on paper, structurally slow or inaccessible: Japan's venue base is overwhelmingly independents; Korea faces demographic headwinds on social events; China is effectively closed to a US SaaS entrant.

Recommendation: sequence, don't scatter — prove the model where conditions are friendliest, fund the harder markets with the learning.

Numbers that made the argument for me

\$8.9B

Singapore MICE market by 2032, from \$4.8B in 2025 — a 9.2% CAGR in a city with 1,700+ bookable venues.

COHERENT MARKET INSIGHTS

\$228.7B

India wedding-services market by 2030 (14.3% CAGR), across 8–10M weddings a year — with catering & venues the largest segment.

GRAND VIEW RESEARCH • CAIT

~75%

of India's wedding bookings still happen offline — the same pre-digital condition Tripleseat was founded to fix in the US in 2008.

INDUSTRY ESTIMATES

+58%

YoY growth in India's branded-hotel development pipeline (114–144K rooms) — the exact segment most likely to buy venue software.

HOTELIVATE • HORWATH HTL

I argued against my own strongest market



The counterweight I added

A banquet or events coordinator in India earns roughly ₹3–6 lakh (~\$3,500–7,000) a year. Venues can simply hire more admin staff cheaply — which quietly breaks the classic “software replaces labor” ROI pitch, even in the highest event-volume market on earth.

I put this in the brief deliberately: it pushes back on the document's own most exciting number, and that is what makes the rest of it credible.

So the value proposition moved

Rebuilt around what cheap labor can't do:



Revenue, not cost — Lead capture and response speed — won bookings scale with volume regardless of wages.



Coordination at scale — Multi-property visibility and double-booking prevention across high-volume calendars.



Owner-level control — Portfolio reporting no amount of extra admin headcount produces.



Sharper targeting — Aim the India GTM at chains and multi-venue operators — not independent banquet halls.

A pilot leadership could actually run



Australia test

POSITIONING

Venue-first system for selling more private events — set directly against iVvy's documented onboarding and reporting complaints.

CHANNELS

LinkedIn ABM, paid search, hospitality associations, hotel trade groups, webinars.

METRICS

CTR → demo conversion → SQL rate, target-account engagement, pipeline value, sales-cycle feedback.



Singapore test

POSITIONING

Convert BEiS-fuelled corporate event demand faster with modern venue sales and event workflows.

CHANNELS

LinkedIn ABM, paid search, the SECB / business-events ecosystem, executive content.

METRICS

Demo conversion, SQL rate, account quality, buyer interviews, competitive win/loss feedback.

Financial model: structure, not theatre. The assessment defines the TAM / SAM / SOM, CAC, support-burden and payments-upside model for leadership to populate with internal data — and deliberately refuses to invent revenue projections it can't support.

Objections answered before they were raised



“We sell to venues and hotels — not weddings or corporate planners.”

Agreed — and the paper never suggests otherwise. The customer in every tier is the venue; weddings and MICE are the demand flowing through venues. “Banquet halls in India” and “the Indian wedding market” are the same data, deliberately kept in the venue framing.



“Why not just keep compounding the US and UK?”

Not either/or. The assessment argues sequencing, not reallocation — a bounded, measurable pilot that runs alongside the core business, with kill criteria defined up front.



“How much of this can we trust?”

The document includes its own ‘Honest limitations’ section: where estimates diverge between sources, where public data thins out, and which assumptions require internal numbers to resolve.

From side observation to the leadership table



Forwarded upward

The Creative Director shared the assessment package with senior leadership — exactly the outcome the “put it in writing” brief asked for.



Authored end to end

All three documents — summary, brief, and 15-page assessment — researched, structured, written, and designed by me alone, under my name.



A repositioned profile

Inside the company, the work moved my profile from ‘the designer’ toward someone who thinks in markets, evidence, and go-to-market sequence — the exact muscle a PMM role runs on.

Honest framing: market entry is a multi-quarter decision and the pilot is leadership's call to green-light. What this case study evidences is the PMM craft — the research, the framework, the positioning, and a document senior stakeholders chose to pass upward.

The PMM toolkit, shown not claimed



Market research & sizing

Multi-source sizing across 14 markets; TAM/SAM/SOM structure; source triangulation and honest ranges.



Segmentation & prioritisation

A weighted, seven-lens scoring model that turned a region into a defensible three-tier sequence.



Competitive intelligence

Cvent, iVvy, Social Tables, Prismm mapped — including attackable weaknesses to position against.



Positioning & messaging

Country-specific value propositions, rebuilt where the evidence (labor cost) broke the default ROI story.



GTM & pilot design

Two-market pilot with channels, assets, metrics, and kill criteria — scoped for real budget approval.



Executive communication

Three formats for three attention spans; objections pre-answered; limitations disclosed.

THANK YOU

Let's build the next market story together.

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